

Herbs that Clear Heat and Eliminate Toxicity

- Cold, bitter, sweet, and salty tastes
- Indicated for various clinical conditions associated with heat toxins (Re du).
- Infections:
 - Purulent infections: sores, mastitis, pulmonary and breast abscesses.
 - Burns and wounds
 - Dysentery, mumps, sore throat.

Name	Similarities	Differences
Jin Yin Hua (Flos Lonicerae)	Clear heat, eliminate toxins, reduce abscesses, sores, and swellings	Treats wind-heat, heat in various stages of febrile disorders, dysentery, and intestinal abscesses
Lian Qiao (Fructus Forsythiae)		Treats wind-heat, clears heart fire, dissipates nodules, and expels abscesses.
Pu Gong Ying (Herba Taraxaci)		Treats breast (Lung, intestines) abscesses, promotes urination, treats jaundice
Zi Hua Di Ding (Herba Violae)		Treats breast (intestines) abscesses, treats skin lesions, and snake bites.
Ye Ju Hua (Flos Chrysanthemi Indici)		Treats skin and eye disorders
Niu Huang (Calculus Bovis)		Opens the orifices, extinguishes wind, and transforms phlegm
Bai Xian Pi (Cortex Dictamni)		Clears damp-heat and alleviates itching
Ban Lan Gen (Radix Isatidis)	Clear heat, eliminate toxins, cool blood, and disperse spots on the skin	Relieves a sore throat
Da Qing Ye (Folium Isatidis)		Treats infectious respiratory disorders and purpura
Qing Dai (Indigo Naturalis)		Clears Liver fire and Lung heat, treats purpura
Yu Xing Cao (Herba Houttuyniae)	Clear heat, eliminate toxins from the Lung	Expels pus, drains Lung abscesses
She Gan (Rhizoma Belamcandae)		Benefits the throat, transforms phlegm, and treats a sore throat.

Shan Dou Gen (Radix Sophorae Tonkinensis)	Clear heat, eliminate toxins from the Lung	Benefits the throat, reduces swellings, and treats cancer.
Ma Bo (Lasiosphaera seu Calvatia)		Benefits the throat, stops bleeding.
Chuan Xin Lian (Herba Andrographis)		It strongly eliminates toxins and clears damp-heat in the lower jiao.
Qin Pi (Cortex Fraxini)	Clear heat, eliminate toxins, treat dysentery and diarrhea	Clears Liver fire, treats bacterial dysentery
Bai Tou Weng (Radix Pulsatillae)		Cools blood, treats amoebic and bacterial dysentery with toxic heat, mucus, and blood.
Bai Jiang Cao (Herba cum Radice Patriniae)		Dispels pus, dispels blood stasis, and relieves pain.
Tu Fu Ling (Rhizoma Smilacis Glabrae)	Clears heat, eliminates toxins, dispels dampness	Treats syphilis, treats cancer
Lu Dou (Semen Phaseoli Radiati)	Clear summer-heat and relieve thirst	clears heat, eliminates toxins, detoxifies other herbs (antidote)
He Ye (Folium Nelumbinis)		Stops bleeding
Bai Hua She She Cao (Herba Oldenlandia)	Clear heat, eliminate toxins, treat cancer	Promotes urination, clears damp-heat, treats cancer
Ban Zhi Lian (Herba Scutellariae Barbatae)		Promotes urination

Jīn Yín Huā 金银花

Flos Lonicerae Japonicae

English: honeysuckle flower, lonicera

Properties: sweet, cold

Channels: Lung, Stomach, Large Intestine

Actions and Indications

Actions: Expels externally contracted wind-heat

Indications: for the early stages of warm-febrile disease with such symptoms as fever, slight sensitivity to wind, sore throat, and headache.

- Wind-heat invasion
 - Bo He, Lian Qiao, Jing Jie (Yin Qiao San)
- Warm febrile disease
- Heat in the qi level
 - Shi Gao, Zhi Mu, Lian Qiao
- Heat in the blood level
 - Sheng Di Huang, Mu Dan Pi

Actions: Clears heat and relieves fire toxicity

Indications: for hot, painful sores and swellings in various stages of development; especially for breast, throat, or eyes.

- Sores, lesions, carbuncles
 - Pu Gong Ying, Zi Hua Di Ding (wu wei xiao du yin)
- Can use fresh herbs topically
- Intestinal abscess
 - Yi Yi Ren, Huang Qin, Dang Gui

Actions: Eliminates toxicity, cools the blood, and stops diarrhea

Indications: for damp-heat dysenteric disorders

- Bai Tou Weng, Huang Lian, Huang Bai

Main Actions:

- Clears heat and relieves fire toxicity

Dosage: 10-15 grams in decoctions.

NOTE: Treatment of EPI with Jin Yin Hua requires smaller dosages, while treatment of heat and toxins requires larger dosages.

Fresh Jin Yin Hua is more effective in releasing heat toxicity, cooling blood, and stopping diarrhea.

Lián Qiào 连翘

Fructus Forsythiae Suspensae

English: forsythia fruit

Properties: bitter, slightly acrid, cool

Channels: Heart, Liver, Gallbladder

Actions and Indications

Actions: Expels externally contracted wind-heat:

Indications: for wind-heat or early febrile disorders, with such symptoms as pronounced fever, slight chills, sore throat, and headache.

- Jin Yin Hua (yin qiao san)

Indications: internal heat affecting the Heart and Pericardium, causing high fever, irritability, and delirium.

- Xi Jiao, Huang Lian, Zhi Zi
- One of the most effective and commonly used herbs to clear heat, eliminate toxins, and dissipate nodules

Indications: for all hot sores, sore throat, carbuncles, neck lumps, and nodules.

- Ye Ju Hua, Jin Yin Hua, Tian Hua Fen, Xia Ku Cao, Xuan Shen, Bei Mu

Main Actions:

- Expels externally contracted wind-heat
- Clears heat from the Heart and Pericardium (upper Jiao Heat)
- Eliminate toxins and dissipate nodules

Dosage: 5-15 grams in decoctions

Cautions: Use Lian Qiao with caution for patients with diarrhea or sores that are neither red nor painful

Review Questions for Jin Yin Hua and Lian Qiao:

- What are the channels and properties of these herbs?
- What are the actions and indications of these herbs?
- What herbs combine with wind-heat clearing herbs to treat wind-heat invasion?
- What is the most effective and common herb used for treating infectious conditions, such as skin sores, lesions, and carbuncles, due to heat toxins? (Sheng Yao)
- What herbs treat dysenteric disorders or intestinal abscesses? (Jin Yin Hua)
- Lian Qiao Xin clears heat from the heart?

- What herbs treat neck lumps and nodules?

Pǔ Gōng Yīng 蒲公英

Herba Taraxaci Mongolici cum Radice

English: dandelion

Properties: bitter, sweet, cold

Channels: Liver, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat and eliminates fire toxin

Indications: for abscesses and sores, especially if they are firm and hard

- Carbuncles, furuncles, and ulceration of the skin
 - Jin Yin Hua, Lian Qiao, Ye Ju Hua
- Breast abscess
 - Zi Hua Di Ding, internal & topical
- Lung abscess
 - Yu Xing Cao, Lu Gen, Dong Gua Ren
- Intestinal abscess
 - Chi Shao, Mu Dan Pi, Da Huang

Actions: Treats red, swollen eyes

- Long Dan Cao, Ju Hua, Huang Qin

Actions: Clears heat, promotes urination, and relieves toxins

Indications: for damp-heat jaundice and painful urinary dysfunction.

- Damp-heat jaundice
 - Yin Chen, Da Huang, Huang Qin
- Difficult urination
 - Jin Qian Cao, Che Qian Zi

Main Actions:

- Clears heat and eliminates fire toxin
- Promotes urination and relieves toxins

Dosage: 10-30 grams

Note: A large dose of fresh Pu Gong Ying is usually crushed into a paste for topical application. Large doses are sometimes associated with diarrhea.

Yě Jú Huā 野菊花

Flos Chrysanthemi Indici

English: wild chrysanthemum flower, flower of indian dendranthem

Properties: bitter, acrid, cool

Channels: Lung, Liver

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat and eliminates toxins

Indications: carbuncles, furuncles, sores, sore throat, and red eyes.

Main Actions:

- Clears heat and eliminates toxins

Dosage: 10 – 15 grams in decoction.

Note: Ye Ju Hua may be used both internally and externally.

Review Questions:

- What are the channels and properties of these herbs?
- What are the actions and indications of these herbs?
- Which three herbs can be used internally and topically for infectious skin conditions?
- What herbs can treat a variety of abscess conditions?
- What herbs are specifically used to treat breast abscesses?

Niú Huáng 牛黄

Calculus Bovis

English: cattle gallstone

Properties: bitter, cool

Channels: Heart, Liver

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears the Heart and Liver, opens the orifices, awakens the spirit, and transforms phlegm:

Indications: for delirium or coma due to warm-febrile or hot disease with hot phlegm obstructing the Pericardium

Actions: Clears the Heart, relieves toxicity, extinguishes wind, transforms phlegm, and stops tremors:

Indications: for spasms, tremors, epilepsy, or convulsions with high fever due to heat entering the Heart (Pericardium) or Liver.

- An Gong Niu Huang Wan

Actions: Drains heat and relieves fire toxicity:

Indications: for red, painful, swollen, or ulcerated throat; also for sores, carbuncles, boils, and a wide variety of hot swellings.

Main Actions:

- Clears heat (Heart and Liver), eliminates toxins
- Opens the orifices, extinguishes wind, and transforms phlegm

Dosage: 0.2-0.5 grams

Note: Ren Gong Niu Huang (Calculus Bovis Syntheticum) is often used as a substitute for Niu Huang.

- Use with caution during pregnancy and in patients not presenting with excess heat.

Bái Xiān Pí 白鲜皮

“white fresh bark”

Cortex Dictamni Dasycarpi

English: cortex of Chinese dittany root

Properties: bitter, cold

Channels: Spleen, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat, relieves fire toxicity, clears damp-heat, and alleviates itching.

Indications: dermatological disorders caused by damp-heat

Note: Bai Xian Pi is used most often to treat sores, carbuncles, rashes, eczema, ulcerations, and similar conditions. In these cases, there is usually profuse oozing of fluids and ulceration of lesions.

Indications: For skin conditions, it can be combined with: Huang Bai, Ku Shen, Fang Feng

Actions: Clears heat, relieves fire toxicity, and eliminates dampness:

Main Actions:

- Clears heat, relieves toxicity
- Clears damp-heat and alleviates itching.

Dosage: 6 – 10 grams in decoction.

Note: Bai Xian Pi is used internally or topically.

Review Questions

- What are the channels and properties of Bai Xian Pi?
- What are the actions and indications of Bai Xian Pi?
- What are the premier herbs for skin conditions?
- What herbs can combine with Bai Xian Pi for treating many skin conditions? (Huang Bai, Ku Shen, Fang Feng)

Bǎn Lán Gēn 板蓝根

Radix Isatidis

English: isatis root, indigo woad root

Properties: bitter, cold

Channels: Heart, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat, eliminates toxins, cools blood, and benefits the throat.

Indications: warm febrile disease, sore throat, sores, lesions, mumps, etc.

Main Actions:

- Clears heat, eliminates toxins
- Cools blood and benefits the throat

Dosage: 10-15 grams in decoction.

Dà Qīng Yè 大青叶

Folium Daqingye

English: woad leaf, indigo

Properties: bitter, very cold

Channels: Heart, Lung, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat, cools the blood, eliminates toxins, and reduces blotches

Indications: for epidemic toxins entering the blood with high fever, irritability, blotches, or purpura.

- Warm febrile disease, heat entering the blood.
 - Xi Jiao, Zhi Zi (xi jiao da qing tang)
- Wind-heat, early febrile disease, fever, headache, thirst, sore throat, etc.
 - Jin Yin Hua, Lian Qiao, Jing Jie, Niu Bang Zi

Actions: Clears heat and relieves fire toxicity, benefits the throat. Can use fresh.

Indications: for sore throat, canker sores, and toxic heat conditions.

- Can use fresh juice of Da Qing Ye

Main Actions:

- Clears heat, eliminates toxicity – Cools blood and reduces blotches

Dosage: 10-15 grams in decoction.

Cautions: Use with caution when patients have deficient cold due to Spleen and Stomach deficiency.

Qīng Dài 青黛

Indigo Pulverata Levis

English: indigo

Properties: salty, cold

Channels: Liver, Lung, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat and relieves fire toxicity

Indications: used topically for inflammation of the oral cavity and throat (including mumps)

Actions: Cools the blood and eliminates toxicity

Indications: for blotches due to heat toxin, or bleeding due to the reckless movement of blood

- Warm febrile disease leading to fever, irritability, blotches, etc.
 - Shi Gao, Sheng Di, Sheng M
- Bleeding due to heat.
- Qing Dai can be used alone or combined with:
 - Che Bai Ye, Bai Mao Gen

Actions: Clears heat from the Liver and GB and eliminates toxicity

Indications: for febrile convulsions in children

Actions: Clears heat from the Lung

Indications: Lung heat causing cough with difficult breathing and thick, sticky Tan

- Gua Lou Ren, Bei Mu, Fu Hai Shi

Actions: Clears heat, eliminates toxins, cools blood, and reduces swelling

Indications: heat toxins causing skin sores, lesions, or mumps

- Jin Yin Hua, Lian Qiao, Xuan Shen

Main Actions:

- Clears heat and relieves fire toxicity
- Cools blood and eliminates toxicity

Dosage: 1.5-3 grams as powder.

Note:

- Qing Dai can be used topically for infectious skin lesions or snake bites.
- Nausea, vomiting, abdominal pain, and diarrhea may occur with overdose.
- Use with caution in patients who have deficiency and cold of the Stomach.

Review Questions

- What are the channels and properties of these herbs?
- What are the actions and indications of these herbs?
- The herbs are from the same plant.
- What herbs are Anti-viral?
- What herb treats leukemia?
- What are the differences between these three herbs?

Yú Xīng Cǎo 鱼腥草

Herba cum Radice Houttuyniae Cordatae

English: houttuynia

Properties: acrid, cool

Channels: Large Intestine, Lung

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat, eliminates toxins, and drains pus:

Indications: for Lung abscesses, Lung heat cough, or infectious skin lesions

- Cough due to Lung heat with expectoration of thick, yellow-green sputum
- Zhi Mu, Zhe Bei Mu, Sang Bai Pi
- Lung abscess
- Jie Geng, Yi Yi Ren, Lu Gen, Dong Gua Ren

Actions: Relieves toxicity and expels pus:

Indications: for toxic sores; used internally and topically

- Ye Ju Hua, Pu Gong Ying, Lian Qiao

Actions: Drains damp-heat and promotes urination:

Indications: for Large Intestine damp-heat diarrhea or damp-heat in the lower burner with painful urinary dysfunction.

Main Actions:

- Clears heat, eliminates toxicity, and drains pus
- Drains damp-heat and promotes urination

Dosage: 15 – 30 grams in decoction.

Note: Yu Xing Cao can be used internally and topically for infectious skin disorders.

Review Questions

- What are the channels and properties of Yu Xing Cao?
- What are the actions and indications of Yu Xing Cao?
- What are the premier herbs for treating Lung abscesses?
- What herbs treat Lung Heat leading to cough with yellow sputum?

Shè Gān 射干

Rhizoma Belamcandae Chinensis

English: Belamcanda rhizome

Properties: bitter, cold

Channels: Lung

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat, relieves toxicity, transforms phlegm, and benefits the throat.

Indications: for pain and swelling of the throat due to fire excess, fire toxin or phlegm-heat obstruction; sometimes used alone for sore throat.

- Huang Qin, Jie Geng, Sheng Ma

Actions: Transforms phlegm and clears the Lung

Indications: for cough and wheezing with excess phlegm obstruction.

- Phlegm-heat obstructing the Lung
 - Huang Qin, Sang Bai Pi, Zhi Mu
- Cold-phlegm obstructing the Lung
 - Xi Xin, Sheng Jiang, Ban Xia

Main Actions:

- Clears heat and relieves toxicity
- Transforms phlegm and benefits the throat.

Dosage: 6 – 10 grams in decoction.

Cautions: contraindicated during pregnancy; use with caution for patients with deficiency and cold of the Spleen and Stomach.

Shān Dou Gēn 山豆根

Radix Sophorae Tonkinensis

English: subprostrate, sophora root

Properties: bitter, cold

Channels: Lung

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat, relieves toxicity, and improves the condition of the throat

Indications: for a swollen, painful throat. It has marked effectiveness in clearing heat and eliminating toxins.

- Shan Dou Gen is one of the most common and effective herbs for treating a sore throat.
- Mild sore throat: Use Shan Dou Gen alone as an herbal decoction or herbal gargle.
- Severe sore throat: Use with Xuan Shen, Ban Lan Gen, She Gan

Actions: Clears heat from the Lung, reduces swelling, and alleviates pain.

Indications: for cough due to Lung heat or infectious skin lesions, it can also be used to treat Lung, breast, and throat cancer.

Actions: Also used for damp-heat jaundice:

Indications: damp-heat jaundice

Main Actions:

- Clears heat, relieves toxicity, and benefits the throat
- Clears heat from the Lung, reduces swelling, and alleviates pain

Dosage: 6 – 10 grams in decoction.

Cautions: contraindicated in patients with deficiency and cold of the Spleen and Stomach, decreased appetite, and loose stools.

Overdose: An overdose of Shan Dou Gen may cause varying degrees of abdominal pain, dizziness, nausea, vomiting, pale face, increased or decreased heart rate, headache, weakness of the extremities, tremors, profuse perspiration, increased BP, and loss of balance.

Mǎ Bó 马勃

Fructificatio Lasiosphaerae seu Calvatiae

English: fruiting body of puffball, lasiosphaera

Properties: acrid, neutral

Channels: Lung

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat, relieves toxicity, and improves the condition of the throat:

Indications: for fire toxin affecting the throat, causing pain, swelling, loss of voice, or cough.

- Ma Bo can be used alone in powder form for a sore throat.
- EPI leading to sore throat:
 - Xuan Shen, Jie Geng, Ban Lan Gen
- Difficulty swallowing due to a swollen, painful throat:
 - Mang Xiao, She Gan, Sheng Ma

Actions: Stops bleeding:

Indications: used topically to stop bleeding, most often in the oral cavity or lips. It is also used for traumatic injury.

Main Actions:

- Clears heat, relieves toxicity, and benefits the throat
- Stops bleeding

Dosage: 3 – 6 grams in decoction.

Note:

- Ma Bo should be wrapped in cheesecloth prior to cooking.

- Ma Bo can be placed directly on the throat in powder form to reduce swelling and pain.

Review Questions

- What are the channels and properties of these herbs?
- What are the actions and indications of these herbs?
- What are the premier herbs for treating a sore throat?
- What are the differences between She Gan and Shan Dou Gen?
- Ma Bo stops bleeding

Chuān Xīn Lián 穿心莲

Herba Andrographitis

English: green chiretta, kariyat, andrographis

Properties: bitter, cold

Channels: Large Intestine, Lung, Small Intestine, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat and eliminates toxins:

Indications: for a wide variety of heat accumulation and toxic disorders, including heat in the Lung, throat, and urinary tract

- Cough and wheezing due to Lung heat
 - Huang Qin, Sang Bai Pi, Di Gu Pi
- Lung abscess
 - Yu Xing Cao, Jie Geng, Dong Gua Ren
- Early stages of warm febrile disease characterized by fever, thirst, headache, and sore throat.
 - Jin Yin Hua, Niu Bang Zi Jie Geng

Actions: Clears heat and dries dampness:

Indications: for damp-heat dysenteric disorders, hot painful urinary dysfunction, and eczema

- Lin Zheng (dysuria syndrome) with frequent urge to urinate, painful urination, and scanty, yellow urine
 - Che Qian Zi, Hu Zhang, Huang Bai, Bai Mao Gen
- Diarrhea or dysentery due to damp-heat:

- Ma Chi Xian, Jin Yin Hua
- Eliminates toxins and reduces swelling
 - Crush fresh Chuan Xin Lian into a paste as a topical application for snakebite, carbuncles, or furuncles.

Main Actions:

- Clears heat and eliminates toxins
- Clears heat and dries dampness
- Topical application for infectious skin lesions and snake bites.

Dosage: 6-15 grams.

- Chuan Xin Lian is more commonly used in tablet, pill, or granular form.
- Chuan Xin Lian is cold and bitter; Large doses or long-term use may injure the Stomach.
- Chuan Xin Lian must be used with caution during pregnancy.

Review Questions

- What are the channels and properties of Chuan Xin Lian?
- What are the actions and indications of Chuan Xin Lian?
- What herb is used as an herbal antibiotic to treat URI, Lung heat, Lung abscess, UTI, and dysenteric disorders?

Qín Pí 秦皮

Cortex Fraxini

English: fraxinus bark, Korean ash bark, ash bark

Properties: bitter, cold

Channels: Large Intestine, Liver, Gallbladder

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat and eliminates toxins:

Indications: for damp-heat, bloody dysenteric disorders or damp-heat leukorrhea with foul-smelling, yellow, turbid discharge

- Huang Lian, Bai Tou Weng

Actions: Clears Liver fire and brightens the eyes:

Indications: for Liver heat affecting the eyes, causing redness, swelling, pain, or superficial visual obstruction.

Main Actions:

- Clears heat and eliminates toxins
- Clears Liver heat and brightens the eyes

Dosage: 6 – 12 grams in decoction.

Review Questions

- What are the channels and properties of Qin Pi?
- What are the actions and indications of Qin Pi?
- What herbs treat diarrhea with/without bloody mucus?
- What herbs treat liver heat leading to red, swollen eyes?

Bái Tóu Wēng 白头翁

“white headed gentleman”

Radix Pulsatillae Chinensis

English: Chinese anemone root, pulsatilla

Properties: bitter, cold

Channels: Large Intestine

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat, relieves fire toxicity, and cools blood:

Indications: It is an essential herb in treating dysentery due to damp-heat in the Large Intestine, causing diarrhea with mucus and blood, abdominal pain, and frequent urge to defecate.

Main Actions:

- Clears heat, relieves fire toxicity, and cools blood.

Dosage: 6-15 grams in decoction.

Review Questions

- What are the channels and properties of these herbs?
- What are the actions and indications of these herbs?

- Which herbs can be combined to treat damp-heat diarrhea with bloody mucus?
 - (Huang Lian, Huang Bai, Huang Qin, Jin Yin Hua)

Bài Jiàng Cǎo 败酱草

“spoiled paste herb”

Herba cum Radice Patriniae

English: patrinia, thiaspi

Properties: acrid, bitter, slightly cold

Channels: Large Intestine, Liver, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat, relieves toxicity & expels pus:

Indications: for internal fire toxin disorders, such as Intestinal or Lung abscesses, or fire toxin surface sores and swellings

- Lung abscess
 - Yu Xing Cao, Lu Gen, Jie Geng
- Intestinal abscess
 - With pus: Yi Yi Ren, Fu Zi
 - Without pus: Jin Yin Hua, Mu Dan Pi
- Carbuncles or furuncles due to heat toxin;
- Fresh herb is used internally or topically.

Actions: Dispels blood stasis and stops pain

Indications: for pain and obstruction associated with heat-induced blood stasis, especially in the abdomen and chest

Main Actions:

- Clears heat, relieves toxicity & expels pus
- Dispels blood stasis and stops pain

Dosage: 6-15 grams in decoction.

Tǔ Fú Líng 土茯苓

Rhizoma Smilacis Glabrae

English: glabrous greenbrier rhizome, smilax

Properties: sweet, bland, neutral

Channels: Liver, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Relieves toxicity, eliminates dampness, and benefits the joints:

Indications: for treating syphilis (spirochetosis) caused by toxic heat or damp-heat; also for spasms in extremities from mercury poisoning

- Jin Yin Hua, Bai Xian Pi, Gan Cao

Actions: Clears damp-heat from the skin:

Indications: for treating rashes, carbuncles, ulcers, and hot skin lesions.

Actions: Dispels damp-heat from the lower jiao, relieves toxicity, and eliminates dampness

Main Actions:

- Relieves toxicity, eliminates dampness, and benefits the joints
- Anti-cancer

Dosage: 15-60 grams in decoction

Review Questions

- What are the channels and properties of Tu Fu Ling?
- What are the actions and indications of Tu Fu Ling?
- What herbs treat syphilis?

Lù Dòu 绿豆

Semen Phaseoli Radiati

English: mung bean

Properties: sweet, cool

Channels: Heart, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears summer-heat, eliminates irritability, and relieves thirst

Indications: for summer-heat patterns of irritability and fever, especially when thirst is an important symptom. Use as food or a dessert

Actions: Clears heat and eliminates toxins

Indications: carbuncles, furuncles, sores, and ulcers due to heat and toxicity. It can be applied topically in combination with:

- Da Huang, Bo He, and honey

Actions: Antidote

Indications: used as an antidote to fu zi, ba dou, and other poisons. Powder it and soak in cold water.

- Gan Cao

Main Actions:

- Clears summer-heat, eliminates irritability, and relieves thirst
- Clears heat, eliminates toxins, and reduces swelling
- Antidote

Dosage: 15-30 grams in decoction

Review Questions

- What are the channels and properties of Lu Dou?
- What are the actions and indications of Lu Dou?
- What herbs clear summer heat? (Qing Hao)
- What herbs are used as an antidote?

He Ye 荷叶

Nelumbinis Folium

English: lotus leaf

Properties: bitter, astringent, neutral

Channels: Heart, Liver, Spleen

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears summer-heat and dissolves dampness

Indications: for summer-heat patterns of irritability and fever, thirst, sweating, and scanty urine.

- Jin Yin Hua, Bian Dou, Hou Po

Actions: Treats obesity

- Cook He Ye and Yi Yi Ren together and drink daily as tea.

Actions: Stops bleeding (charred He Ye)

- It is commonly used with other herbs that stop bleeding.

Main Actions:

- Clears summer-heat and dissolves dampness
- Stops bleeding

Dosage: 3 - 10 grams in decoction

- Unprocessed He Ye functions more effectively to clear heat.
- The charred herb (He Ye Tan) is more effective in stopping bleeding.

Review Questions:

- What are the channels and properties of He Ye?
- What are the actions and indications of He Ye?
- What herbs clear summer heat?
- What herbs stop bleeding?

Bái Huā Shé Shé Cǎo 白花蛇舌草

“white flower snake tongue herb”

Herba Hedyotidis Diffusae

English: heydyotis, oldenlandia

Properties: bitter, sweet, cold

Channels: Stomach, Large Intestine

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat, strongly relieves toxicity, and reduces abscesses:

Indications: for Intestinal abscess, toxic sores, ulcerations, and swellings; also for snakebite

- Intestinal abscess:
 - Hong Teng, Bai Jiang Cao, Jin Yin Hua
- Carbuncles, furuncles due to heat toxins
 - Jin Yin Hua, Lian Qiao, Ye Ju Hua
- Snake bite: It can be used fresh and applied topically.

Actions: Clears heat and resolves dampness by promoting urination.

Indications: for hot, painful urinary dysfunction and damp-heat jaundice.

Actions: Clears heat and relieves toxins

Indications: many types of cancer, such as colon, rectal, stomach, and esophageal cancer.

Main Actions:

- Clears heat, relieves toxicity, and reduces abscesses
- Clears heat and resolves dampness
- Anti-cancer

Dosage: 15 – 30 grams in decoction.

- Review Questions for Hong Teng, Bai Jiang Cao, and Bai Hua She She Cao
- What are the channels and properties of these herbs?
- What are the actions and indications of these herbs?
- What herbs treat intestinal abscesses? (Mu Dan Pi)

Ban Zhi Lian 半枝莲

Scutellariae barbatae Herba

English: bearded scutellaria, barbat skullcap

Properties: acrid, slightly bitter, cool

Channels: Liver, Lung, Stomach

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat, resolves toxicity, invigorates the blood, and reduces swelling

Indications: for furuncles, sores, and abscesses, as well as snakebite and trauma. Promotes movement and disperses while in the act of clearing.

- Use with Ye Ju Hua and Zi Hua di ding for furuncles

Actions: Promotes urination and reduces edema

Indications: for edema from such concerns as damp-heat or ascites associated with cirrhosis.

- Use with Ze Xie, Ban Bian Lian for edema

Actions: Mildly dispels blood stasis and stops bleeding

Indications: for trauma, vomiting blood, nosebleeds, or painful bloody urinary dribbling

Main Actions:

- Promotes urination
- Reduces swelling and edema

Dosage: 9-30 grams in decoctions.

Caution: Use with caution during pregnancy due to the draining action

Hóng Téng 红藤 (not on list)

Caulis Sargentodoxae Cuneatae

English: sargentodoxa vine

Properties: bitter, neutral

Channels: Large Intestine

Actions and Indications

Actions: Clears heat, relieves toxicity, reduces abscesses, and stops pain:

Indications: for Intestinal abscess and skin lesions with heat, swelling, and pain.

- Hong Teng is “yao yao” for Intestinal abscess.
- For Intestinal abscess, it can be combined with:
 - Jin Yin Hua, Lian Qiao, Mu Dan Pi
- Carbuncles, furuncles due to heat toxin
 - Jin Yin Hua, Bai Zhi, Chi Shao

Actions: Invigorates the blood, dispels stasis, and relieves pain:

Indications: for trauma, dysmenorrhea, and joint pain

Main Actions:

- Clears heat, relieves toxicity, reduces abscesses, and stops pain
- Dispels stasis and relieves pain

Dosage: 10 – 15 grams in decoction.